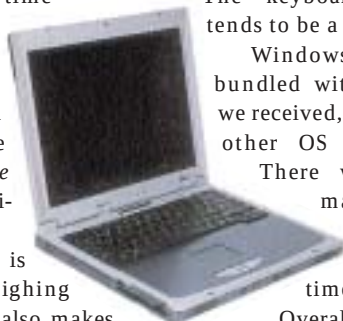


ACi Emerald Pro

A reasonably-priced gem

The Emerald Pro boasts of a 2.4 GHz Pentium 4 processor and 480 MB RAM. It logged an all-time high of 70.6 in Content Creation 2001 and managed a playable 52 fps in *Quake III* at high quality settings.



However, it is quite bulky, weighing 2.8 kg, but this also makes it tough. The Pro has an easy-to-use glide pad and a TFT LCD screen that is clearly visible even from a wide angle. A Web cam that serves the purpose adequately is placed above the LCD screen. The software to capture video images comes pre-loaded.

There are three USB ports, a parallel port, two serial ports, an infrared port, a FireWire port and an Ethernet

Price: Rs 99,000
Contact: Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-26733122
E-mail: sales@aci-asia.com
Web site: www.aci-asia.com

connection. It comes with Realtek Audio'97 soundcard which provides decent sound. The keyboard, however, tends to be a little tacky.

Windows XP came bundled with the laptop we received, but ACi offers other OS options too. There was no user manual, which might annoy first-time users.

Overall, Emerald Pro is an excellent bargain. It may not sport the style of the big brands, but it offers superior performance for business applications at a very reasonable price.

SPECIFICATIONS

P4 2.4 GHz processor, 480 MB
DDR RAM, 15.1-inch LCD
screen, 20 GB hard drive, 24x
CD ROM, 2.8 kg weight

ACi Emerald Pro						A-
Performance	►	►	►	►	►	
Build quality	►	►	►	►	►	
Value for money	►	►	►	►	►	
Features	►	►	►	►	►	
OVERALL	►	►	►	►	►	

beforeSales

For a decent sales pitch

BeforeSales is a software built for sales people who can use it to stay updated with the latest status, be it a customer's account or new products in stock.



The software comprises two parts—a server software to be installed on one centrally located computer and a client software to be installed on other computers.

The software allows you to manage sales campaigns, targets, products, prospects, accounts, etc. It also includes

features such as holiday management, faxing, making phone calls and the like.

The product boasts of management features for each level in the hierarchy of a typical company. For sales representatives, personalisation management, target management and marketing encyclopedia features are very useful.

At the manager level, it offers target management and tracking, and funnel management, which effectively keeps

an eye on the sales process and helps in improving and enhancing the sales cycle.

The software provides security options so you can give a separate set of privileges to different members. The Membership Management feature allows you to create hierarchies and establish roles and responsibilities for each level. User-level access is maintained by Access Management and the users can be linked to particular branches by the Branch Manager.

A mail client also comes bundled with the package and users can send SMS and

Price: Rs 14,900 (for 5 users)
Contact: Questech India Ltd
Phone: 080-25524771
Fax: 080-25524772
E-mail: info@before-sales.com
Web site: www.before-sales.com

e-mail directly through the software—the Configuration Management feature allows you to link the system with SMS providers as well as Web-based e-mail service providers such as Hotmail, Yahoo! and Rediff.

beforeSales is available for Rs 14,900 for five users; you pay an additional Rs 3,000 for every extra user.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: Pentium III or above, 64 MB RAM, Windows 95/98/NT/2000/Me/XP, CD-ROM drive

beforeSales	B+				
Performance	▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Ease of Use	▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Value for money	▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Features	▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
OVERALL	▶	▶	▶	▶	▶

logear GME221 USB Optical Mini Mouse

Easy and fast

The GME221 is a mouse for the mobile user. It comes with a smart leather carrying case, a user's guide and a three-year limited warranty.

The mouse looks very attractive in its metallic blue and silver case and is very light, weighing approximately 60 grams.

The mouse has two buttons and a rubber scroll wheel. It is easy to manoeuvre but might feel a little too small in your hands if you are accustomed to the size of the regular mice. Its small size also means that it takes some effort when one has to alternate between the right and left-click. In spite of all these short-

Price: Rs 2,500
Contact: J.S. Equipments
Phone: 022-23810713
Fax: 022-23860976
E-mail: jse@vsnl.com
Web site: www.jogear.com



comings, it is definitely faster than a laptop's touchpad.

The scroll wheel is quite smooth—the optical sensor senses the movement 1,500 times per second, providing smooth precision tracking on any surface.

However, the price of Rs 2,500 is a big negative—you can get a decent optical mouse for desktop PCs for about one-third the price.

SPECIFICATIONS

Plug-and-play USB connectivity,
optical sensor tracks movement
1,500 times per second

logear GME221 USB Optical Mini Mouse						B
Performance						
Build quality						
Value for money						
Features						
OVERALL						